

## UNIT 1: VIETNAM PEOPLE'S ARMY

### I. INTRODUCTION

The lecture introduces general information about the Vietnam People's Army, including: history of formation and development, structure and organization; forces under the Ministry of Defense.

### II. TEXT

#### 1. History of formation and development of the Vietnam People's Army.

Under the directive of President Ho Chi Minh and the command of comrade Vo Nguyen Giap, the Viet Nam Propaganda Unit of the Liberation Army, the forerunner of the Vietnam People's Army (VPA), was founded on the basis of revolutionary armed teams in Viet Bac on 22 December 1944 in Nguyen Binh district, Cao Bang province.

Nowadays, the Vietnam People's Army has been built as an Army for combat, active work and production as well as a regular, elite, more and more modern Army to successfully perform its mission of defending the country, contributing actively and effectively to the cause of building up the country.



*The Establishment Ceremony of the Viet Nam Propaganda Unit of Liberation Army (22 December 1944) was held in Tran Hung Dao Forest (Nguyen Binh district, Cao Bang province).*

*Source: 2019 Vietnam National Defence*

## **2. Organisation of the Viet Nam People's Army**

The VPA comprises the Main Force and Local Force, military regions, services, the Border Guard, army corps and arms, a system of logistical support units, technical support units, military academies, officer training schools, research institutes, and economic-defence units.

### *2.1. Ground Forces*

The Ground Forces consist of seven military regions (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 7, and 9) and Ha Noi Capital High Command, four army corps (1, 2, 3, and 4) and six arms (Commando, Artillery, Tank and Armour, Engineering, Signal, and Chemical).

The Ground Forces of Viet Nam are equipped in the modern direction so as to achieve the capabilities of high mobility, strong offensive capabilities and firepower, and fighting in various terrains, in all weathers in conformity with the art of modern people's war. At present, Viet Nam has produced and put into service a number of relatively modern infantry weapons.



*Ground Forces*

### *2.2. Air Defence-Air Force*

The Air Defence-Air Force assumes the responsibilities for both national air defence and air force. It is the core force responsible for the control and defence of the airspace, protection of the nation's critical facilities and the people, and participates in safeguarding seas and islands of the Homeland. The service plays the role of a consultative organ for the Ministry of National Defence on matters concerning the building of the air defence of the Ground Forces and other service and arms air forces,...



*Parachute training at the 916<sup>th</sup> Regiment, 371<sup>th</sup> Division, the Air Defence-Air Force.*

### 2.3. Navy

The Viet Nam People's Navy is the core service in protecting sovereignty, sovereign rights, territorial unity and integrity of Viet Nam's seas and islands and building the national defence posture at sea. The Navy has responsibility to manage and firmly defend the sea waters and islands under Viet Nam's sovereignty, ready for combating independently or participating in combined operations to defeat any aggression at sea. It is also responsible for maintaining security, countering any acts

of violating sovereignty, sovereign rights, jurisdiction and national interests of Viet Nam at sea, and participating in disaster prevention and relief, and search and rescue, securing economic production and other normal activities in Viet Nam's sea waters and islands in conformity with Vietnamese and international laws.



*The 3<sup>rd</sup> Naval Region conducting Zone 1 joint combat exercise*

#### *2.4. Border Guard*

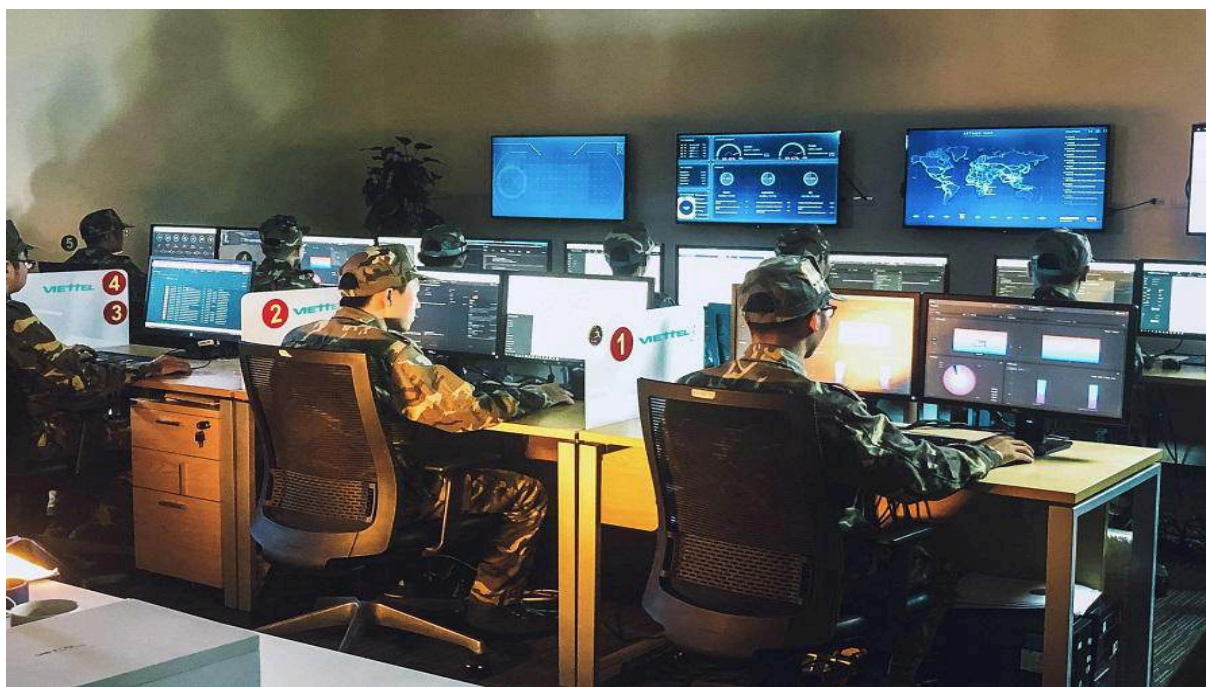


### *Border Guard on their duty*

The Border Guard is the people's armed force of the Communist Party of Vietnam and the State of the Socialist Republic of Viet Nam, constitutes part of the VPA, and plays a core and specialized role in managing and protecting the sovereignty, territorial integrity, security and order of the national borders on land, seas, islands and border gates according to its tasks prescribed by law. It is also a force component in the border provincial and district defence zones.

The Border Guard exercises its functions in accordance with the laws of the Socialist Republic of Viet Nam and international conventions, of which the Socialist Republic of Viet Nam is a signatory, related to sovereignty, security of the national borders on land, seas, islands and border gates.

#### *2.5. Cyber Command*



*Cyber Command Force in their mission*

The Cyber Command is a combat component of the VPA. It plays a core role in defending national sovereignty in cyberspace, countering information warfare, cyberwarfare and safeguarding the Homeland in cyberspace. It is also an important force which participates in protecting national critical information systems, ensuring

information network safety, protecting national network security and countering "peaceful evolution" in cyberspace, contributing to the entire Party, people and military's effort to firmly defend the independence, sovereignty, unity and territorial integrity of the Homeland.

#### *2.6. Viet Nam Peacekeeping Department*



*Viennam Peacekeeping Force on the way to executed the mission*

Viet Nam Peacekeeping Department (previously known as Viet Nam Peacekeeping Centre) is under the direct leadership of the Ministry of National Defence. It is the advisory organ for the Central Military Commission, Minister of National Defence, and the Steering Board of the Ministry of National Defence on the leadership, command, and operation of the VPA's forces participating in the United Nations peacekeeping operations. It also takes charge of the management, command and operation of the whole process of preparation and participation in the United Nations peacekeeping operations and assists the Minister of National Defence in performing the state management of the VPA's United Nations peacekeeping operations.

#### *2.7. Local Force*

The Local Force is a component of the people's three-category armed forces and is organised in provinces, cities, towns and districts. It is a core force in the local people's war, a mobile force engaging in operations mainly in the designated local area, coordinating and working with the Militia and Self-Defence Force, people's public security force in operations, and maintaining the local political security in peacetime

### *2.8. Reserve*

The Reserve is a component of the VPA and an important force, contributing to the building of the all-people national defence and the people's war posture. It is ready to supplement the active force when required, meeting the demands of building and safeguarding the socialist Vietnamese Homeland in the new situation.

*Drill with gun training at army unit*



### *2.9. Academies, Colleges and Schools*

*Participate in the Opening of the Army Day of Books  
and Reading Culture in 2023*

The VPA has a complete system of academies, colleges and schools to meet the demands for training officers and non-commissioned officers as well as technicians at all levels for the VPA, postgraduates and civilian technicians. Those institutions also conduct scientific and technological research in the VPA, foster all

kinds of learners on defence and security knowledge, educate and further advance political theoretical knowledge. The Ministry of National Defence directly administers the National Defence Academy, Political Academy, Army Academy, Logistics Academy, Military Technology Academy, the 1st Army Officer Training College, the 2nd Army Officer Training College, and the Political Officer Training College.

#### *2.10. Major Research Institutes*

Major Research Institutes consist of: *The Institute for Defence Strategy, The Institute of Military Social Sciences and Humanities, The Institute for Military Science and Technology, Viet Nam Institute for Military History, The Institute for Defence International Relations*”.



*Academy of Military Science and Technology*

#### *2.11. Major Economic-Defence Units*

Economic-defence units of the VPA are the leading force in combining economic development with national defence and security consolidation. The VPA's groups, corporations and economic-defence corps have made considerable contributions to the cause of industrialization and modernization of the country, playing the role of a key force in the most difficult regions, participating in local socio-economic development, thus creating strong and stable national defence posture in the vital areas of the Homeland.



*The commanders visited military factories*

### III. GRAMMAR

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#### **\* The passive voice**

##### **a) Use**

- The passive voice is used when we want to emphasize the action (the verb) and the object of a sentence rather than the subject. This means that the subject is either less important than the action itself or that we don't know who or what the subject is.

Eg: The Vietnam People's Army has been built as an Army for combat, active work and production.

The Vietnam People's Army was organized, educated and led by the Vietnamese Communist Party and President Ho Chi Minh.

b) Form

- General structure:

|                |                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Active</b>  | $  \begin{array}{c}  \text{S + V + O} \\  \swarrow \quad \downarrow \quad \searrow \\  \text{S + be* + P.P + by + O} \\  \text{(*be must match the tense of V)}  \end{array}  $ |
| <b>Passive</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                 |

- Passive form of tenses:

| <b>TENSES</b>             | <b>ACTIVE</b>             | <b>PASSIVE</b>                 |
|---------------------------|---------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>Simple Present</b>     | S + V1-s/es               | S + am / is / are + PP         |
| <b>Present continuous</b> | S + am / is / are + V-ing | S + am / is / are + being + PP |
| <b>Simple Past</b>        | S + V-ed /V <sub>2</sub>  | S + was / were + PP            |
| <b>Past continuous</b>    | S + was / were + V-ing    | S + was / were + being + PP    |
| <b>Present Perfect</b>    | S + have / has + PP       | S + have / has + been + PP     |
| <b>Past Perfect</b>       | S + had + PP              | S + had + been + PP            |
| <b>Simple Future</b>      | S + will + V <sub>1</sub> | S + will + be + PP             |

| TENSES             | ACTIVE                                                                     | PASSIVE                                                                         |
|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Modal verbs</b> | can<br>may<br>must<br>S + have to + V1<br>should<br>used to<br>be going to | can<br>may<br>must<br>S + have to + be + V3<br>should<br>used to<br>be going to |

#### IV. VOCABULARY

|   |                       |                                 |   |                                      |
|---|-----------------------|---------------------------------|---|--------------------------------------|
| 1 | army corp             | / 'ɑ:mi kɔ:p/                   | n | Quân đoàn                            |
| 2 | Border Guard          | / 'bɔ:də ɡɑ:d/                  | n | Bộ đội biên phòng                    |
| 3 | conformity            | /kən 'fɔ:məti /                 | a | Phù hợp                              |
| 4 | Cyber Command         | / 'saɪbə kə'mɑ:nd /             | n | Bộ Tư lệnh Tác chiến Không gian mạng |
| 5 | cyberspace            | / 'saɪbə ,speɪs/                | n | Không gian mạng                      |
| 6 | economic-defence unit | / ,i:kə'nɒmɪk-di'fens 'ju:nɪts/ | n | Đơn vị kinh tế quốc phòng            |
| 7 | industrialisation     | /ɪn ,dʌstriələɪ'zeɪʃn /         | n | Công nghiệp hóa                      |
| 8 | local Force           | / 'ləʊkəl fɔ:s/                 | n | Bộ đội địa phương                    |
| 9 | main Force            | /meɪn fɔ:s /                    | n | Bộ đội chủ lực                       |

|    |                            |                                |   |                         |
|----|----------------------------|--------------------------------|---|-------------------------|
| 10 | military region            | /'mɪlɪtəri<br>'ri:ʒənz, /      | n | Quân khu                |
| 11 | modernisation              | /,mɒdʒnaɪ'zeɪʃn /              | n | Hiện đại hóa            |
| 12 | peaceful evolution         | /'pi:sfʊl<br>,i:və'lu:ʃn/      | n | diễn biến hòa bình      |
| 13 | Peacekeeping<br>Department | /'pi:s,ki:pɪŋ<br>di'pɑ:tmənt / | n | Cục Gìn giữ hòa<br>bình |
| 14 | peacetime                  | /'pi:stam/                     | n | Thời bình               |
| 15 | research institute         | /rɪ'sɜ:ʃ 'ɪnstɪtju:ts/         | n | Viện nghiên cứu         |
| 16 | reserve                    | /rɪ'zɜ:v/                      | n | Dự bị động viên         |
| 17 | safeguarding               | /'seɪfgɑ:dɪŋ /                 | n | Sự bảo vệ               |
| 18 | services                   | /'sɜ:vɪsɪz/                    | n | Quân chủng              |
| 19 | sovereign                  | /'sɒvrɪn /                     | n | Chủ quyền               |

## V. PRACTICE

### Exercise 1. Read the text and answer these following questions

1. What was the first name of the Vietnam People's Army when it was founded?

=> .....

2. How many revolutionist combatants were composed of a detachment of Propagandist Soldiers for the Liberation of Vietnam?

=> .....

3. What are the functions of the Vietnam People's Army today?

=> .....  
4. What is the leading organ of the Vietnam People's Army?

=> .....

5. Who is the Vietnam People's Army headed by?

=> .....

6. What does the bureau of the Ministry of Defense consist of?

=> .....

7. What are placed under the authority of the Ministry of Defense?

=> .....

8. What mission has been assigned to the Infantry?

=> .....

9. What mission is Armour used to do?

=> .....

10. What is the Navy responsible for?

=> .....

## **Exercise 2. Transforming the active into the passive**

1. The Vietnamese Communist Party and President Ho Chi Minh organized, educated and led The Vietnam People's Army.

=> .....

2. President Ho Chi Minh formed the Viet Nam Propaganda Unit of the Liberation Army.

=> .....

3. Under the commanding of General Vo Nguyen Giap, Vietnam armed forces surrounded and besieged the French troops in Dien Bien Phu.

=> .....

4. The Air delivered supplies for the troops in the wars.

=> .....

5. The President has the right to direct the Vietnam People's Army.

=> .....

## **Exercise 3. Work in pair. Ask and answer these questions.**

1. What is your current job title?
2. What are your main responsibilities at work?
3. What do you enjoy most about your job?
4. What are your short-term and long-term career goals?
5. How do you plan to achieve these goals?
6. What skills or experiences do you need to develop to reach your goals?

**Exercise 4. Work in group. Ask your friends about the university/college that they used to study at, then complete the table below.**

- What is it?
- Where is it?
- When was it established?
- What did you learn there?
- What do you like/dislike most about studying there?

| <b>Your friends' name</b> | <b>University/ College</b> | <b>Location/ Year of establishment</b> | <b>Things they learnt there</b> | <b>Things they like and dislike</b> |
|---------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
|                           |                            |                                        |                                 |                                     |
|                           |                            |                                        |                                 |                                     |
|                           |                            |                                        |                                 |                                     |
|                           |                            |                                        |                                 |                                     |

|  |  |  |  |  |
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|  |  |  |  |  |
|--|--|--|--|--|

**Exercise 5. Using the information above to talk about your friends university/college.**

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